



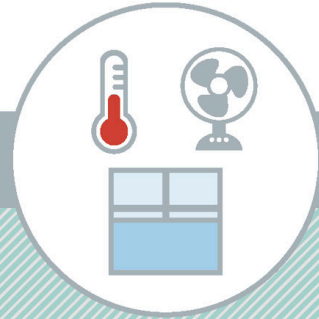
SUITABLE FURNITURE

You will need to provide furniture that supports good posture and that employees can adjust to suit their various needs—particularly if they will be sitting for long periods or may incur strains over time. Many businesses lease their office furniture from specialty suppliers.



LIGHT AND SOUND

Employees will need good lighting to work effectively. Aim for as much natural light as possible—fluorescent lighting should be avoided since it can cause eye strain. Protect staff from high levels of noise or vibration, whether through office design, limiting the use of noisy equipment, or using protective gear.



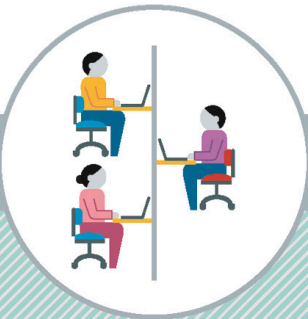
VENTILATION AND TEMPERATURE

Make sure your setting has good ventilation and clean air. A comfortable temperature may depend on the kind of work being done (sedentary work versus physical labor), but temperatures should be adjustable and take into account heat generated by equipment.



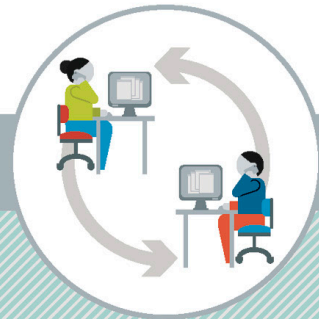
HYGIENE AND SAFETY

You must provide access to toilets and drinking water and will also need to regularly clean your premises. Designate a suitable area for staff to prepare food and drinks. First-aid facilities, smoke detectors, and fire extinguishers are also mandatory (see pp.98–99).



WORKING SPACE

Certain tasks require more space or equipment than others, or can be hazardous or noisy, so plan for this. Other work may involve a need for confidentiality or quiet concentration and require the use of a private area. If possible, also allow for a communal space for informal staff gatherings.



ACCESS

The space must be suitable for all staff, including anyone with a disability. When setting up workstations and facilities, allow enough room to move around freely and safely. Allow sufficient storage for both work-related and personal items to keep floors clear of obstructions and maintain a clear path to fire exits.